RAYMOND CHIZANGA

Integrated Marketing | Brand & Community | Content, SEO & AEO | Operations

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SUMMARY

Integrated marketing, brand and community professional with 7+ years across SaaS, ecommerce, nonprofit and consumer-facing environments, plus hands-on experience in sensory product testing, streetwear retail, hospitality and operations. Background spans social and content strategy, SEO and AI search, lifecycle marketing, consumer research, ecommerce, events, retail buying, brand onboarding and customer experience. Grew Hostfully's owned social audience 235%, impressions 120% and organic review traffic 200%.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Marketing Consultant
October 2026 – Present

Durham Family & Cultural Centre (via DOGHAIR Technologies) · Ajax, ON

- Advise a charity serving Black and racialized families in Durham Region on digital marketing, website strategy and audience engagement.
- Wrote a full website assessment: crawled every live page, checked 384 links and 211 images, and analysed traffic (79% bounce, ~76% mobile, ~63% arriving from Instagram and Facebook).
- Restructured the Squarespace site: unified two event calendars, merged About, Board and Contact, and built Services, Parents Hub, Sponsorships and Work With Us pages with URL redirects.
- Set the redesign direction, replaced AI-generated imagery with real community photography, and brought all linked pages through a WCAG contrast check on desktop and mobile.

Social Media & Content Marketing Consultant
September 2026 (contract)

Edsby · Hybrid

- Contracted to lead social media, content marketing, SEO and AI-search optimization for a K-12 education technology company.
- Delivered a social and SEO strategy (newsletter, posting cadence, channel plans, site recommendations) and a content handoff pack of long-form articles for district leaders.

Consumer Sensory Panelist
2024 – Present

ACCE International · Mississauga, ON

- Participate in recurring paid food and beverage sensory studies, evaluating products across taste, aroma, texture, appearance and overall experience.
- Follow blinded-sample procedures, standardized testing protocols, structured questionnaires and confidentiality requirements to provide consistent product feedback.

Community & Integrated Marketing Manager
December 2023 – May 2026

Hostfully · Remote

- Owned brand presence across LinkedIn, Meta, YouTube, X, Bluesky, TikTok and email, increasing followers 235% and impressions 120%.
- Built email and lifecycle campaigns using audience segmentation, messaging and performance analysis on a Salesforce-based marketing stack.
- Led review-platform strategy, increasing organic G2 and Trustpilot review traffic 200%, while managing partner marketing, customer stories, digital programming and events across Canada and the United States.
- Ran the 10th-anniversary campaign: a 10-week integrated program across four languages that generated 400K+ impressions, 200+ opportunities and a 300+ attendee webinar.
- Produced end-to-end creative across copy, graphic design, video and event production, using analytics and A/B testing to improve performance.

Senior Support Advisor & Technical Content Writer
October 2022 – January 2024

Hostaway · Toronto, ON

- Joined as Technical Support (TS1) and grew into senior support and technical content writing.
- Managed concurrent merchant support workloads while troubleshooting platform issues and translating customer patterns into feedback for product, content and retention initiatives.
- Led software onboarding and staff training while producing technical and marketing content for internal teams and prospective customers.

Support Advisor & Internal Copywriter
October 2021 – July 2022

Shopify · Remote

- Joined as a Junior Support Advisor, supporting ecommerce brands from sole proprietors to enterprise merchants across live service channels.
- Wrote technical copy for internal software and app integrations, onboarding documentation, staff training and product-launch communications.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Warehouse Supervisor
August 2019 – December 2020

Rens Pet Depot · Oakville, ON

- Supervised receiving and warehouse operations at a high-volume pet retailer, processing incoming and outgoing shipments valued up to $100,000 while monitoring inventory, stock accuracy and staff workflow.

Store Manager, Brand & Community Operations
August 2017 – April 2019

Community 54 · Toronto, ON · New York streetwear & cultural concept

- Progressed to independently managing the Toronto storefront, overseeing daily operations, sales, Shopify ecommerce, opening/closing, customer experience and visual merchandising.
- Worked directly under co-founder Daymon Green, gaining hands-on experience in streetwear curation, brand development, retail buying, merchandising and community-led marketing.
- Produced and operated Finale Fridays, Community 54's recurring platform for emerging designers, coordinating promotion, in-store execution and brand/customer engagement.
- Identified and onboarded new brands while managing stock ordering and vendor relationships across independent labels and major brands including Nike, adidas and Supreme.

Prep Supervisor & Line Cook
2012 – 2019

Paradiso Restaurant · Oakville, ON

- Advanced across kitchen support, prep and line responsibilities in a high-volume restaurant, coordinating food preparation, baking, plating, service and event production while supervising and delegating prep work for 2–3 employees and managing stock.

Brand Ambassador — *Get Fresh Company, Toronto, ON.* Supported brand awareness and online sales through social media product promotion and consumer-facing digital campaigns. 2018

Camp Counsellor / Programmer — *Pine Project Summer Camp, Toronto, ON.* Planned and scheduled programming and events for campers, families and staff while coordinating group activities and day-to-day program logistics. June – August 2017

Summer Camp Counsellor — *Peter Gilgan YMCA of Oakville, Oakville, ON.* Completed a full-time nine-week camp term, planning and supervising programming for children ages 4–12 and communicating with parents and guardians. May – August 2013

VENTURES & PROJECTS

DOGHAIR Technologies — *Founder & CEO · design, technology & research company.* Founded and fund the company behind Petworking, The Hoard and D.U.C.K AI; client work includes Durham Family & Cultural Centre.

Petworking — *Founder & CEO · pet care network (beta).* All-in-one network for pet parents, professionals, businesses and rescues around a digital Pet Passport; iPhone, iPad, Apple Watch, Android and web (Expo, Next.js, Supabase, Stripe), in beta in five countries.

The Hoard — *Founder · fan network, live on web and the App Store.* Built solo from concept and architecture through UX/UI and code, including a marketplace and a hand-built pricing tool (Next.js, Expo, Supabase, Stripe).

D.U.C.K AI — *Founder · on-device language model (in development).* From-scratch C++ engine with hand-written PTX GPU kernels and no ML framework; DH-M1 architecture frozen at ~308M parameters.

Highly Animated — *Boutique media & brand management.* Developed independent artist brands through content creation, curation and brand management across creative and digital channels.

SKILLS

Marketing & Community: Content strategy, copywriting, editorial calendars, email and lifecycle marketing, organic social, community engagement, partner marketing, events, review and reputation management.

SEO, Research & Analytics: SEO, AEO/AI-search optimization, keyword and topic strategy, on-page and technical SEO, structured data, A/B testing, campaign analytics, sensory evaluation, consumer and competitive research.

Operations & Customer Experience: Ecommerce, merchant support, retail buying, inventory, stock ordering, vendor relationships, visual merchandising, staff supervision, training, event operations and hospitality.

Platforms & Creative: Salesforce, Zoho, HubSpot, Shopify, Squarespace, Adobe Creative Cloud, Figma, Canva, Premiere Pro, Final Cut Pro, DaVinci Resolve, Pro Tools, HTML/CSS, Next.js and Vercel, ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity and Claude.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

Music Management & Studio Post-Production (coursework) | Metalworks Institute, Mississauga, ON · 2019 · Coursework GPA 4.0

Performance Accreditations | Canadian Music Week, Toronto (2017) · E.L.E Festival, Ottawa (2017)